REMOVEABLE TOP

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REMOVEABLE TOP

STANDARD PROCEDURE

HARD TOP REPAIR

NOTE: The hard top is manufactured from a sheet molded compound (SMC).
SMC is constructed using short fiberglass strands usually less than 5.08 cm (2 inches) long. Sheet stock of glass impregnated resin matting is placed into the mold and pressed under heat to flow material throughout the mold. Tooling is shear edge designed to mold to net (i.e. no trimming at periphery required).
SMC is repairable in accordance with established procedures described within this manual. (Refer to 23 - BODY - STANDARD PROCEDURE - PLASTIC BODY PANEL REPAIR)

Hard Top Locators

There are two hard top locator devices positioned approximately 150 mm (6 in.) from the most forward attachment holes. If the locator device is missing or damaged it must be replaced, as it will assist in placing the hard top back into the correct position for top re-attachment.

If the locator device is missing just make sure that the attachment holes are clear and simply insert the new locator (part is orientated by hole size and inserts from the bottom of the rail before the hard top is re-attached to the vehicle).

If the locator device is damaged, cut off the locking tabs, remove and replace as described above.

HARD TOP REPAIR

If it has been determined that the hard top can be repaired. The following required materials and procedures are to be used.

(1) Use a grinder to remove the paint and outline the damaged area. Use a grade 150 grit disc for paint removal.

(2) Grind the outlined surface area again with a 240 grit disc to prevent coarse scratches from appearing in the final finish.

(3) If cracks extend from the hole, it will be necessary to stop-drill the crack(s) with a 3-mm (1/8-in) diameter drill bit. This will prevent the crack from spreading and allow repair material to be effective.

(4) Position a fiberglass mat or cloth on the repair surface area. Cut the mat 2.5 cm (1 in.) larger than repair area but smaller than the outline area. Make the outline area larger if required.

(5) Clean the outlined area.

(6) Place the fiberglass cloth on aluminum foil.

(7) Pour the fiberglass resin into a clean container.

(8) Mix the appropriate amount of hardener and resin. Follow the manufacturers instructions.

(9) Apply the hardener/resin mixture to both sides of the fiberglass cloth.

(10) Place the fiberglass cloth over the repair area. Next, place the aluminum foil over the cloth using a plastic spreader to smooth-out the cloth and resin. Use firm pressure to remove air bubbles and to smooth-out the cloth. Remove the aluminum foil.

(11) Allow the resin to cure.

(12) Smooth-out the surface area to the contour of the hard top with a 150-grit disc.

(13) Apply plastic filler to complete the repair. Finish smoothing the surface area with 240-320 grit paper.

(14) Repeat the previous steps on the inside area of the hard top.